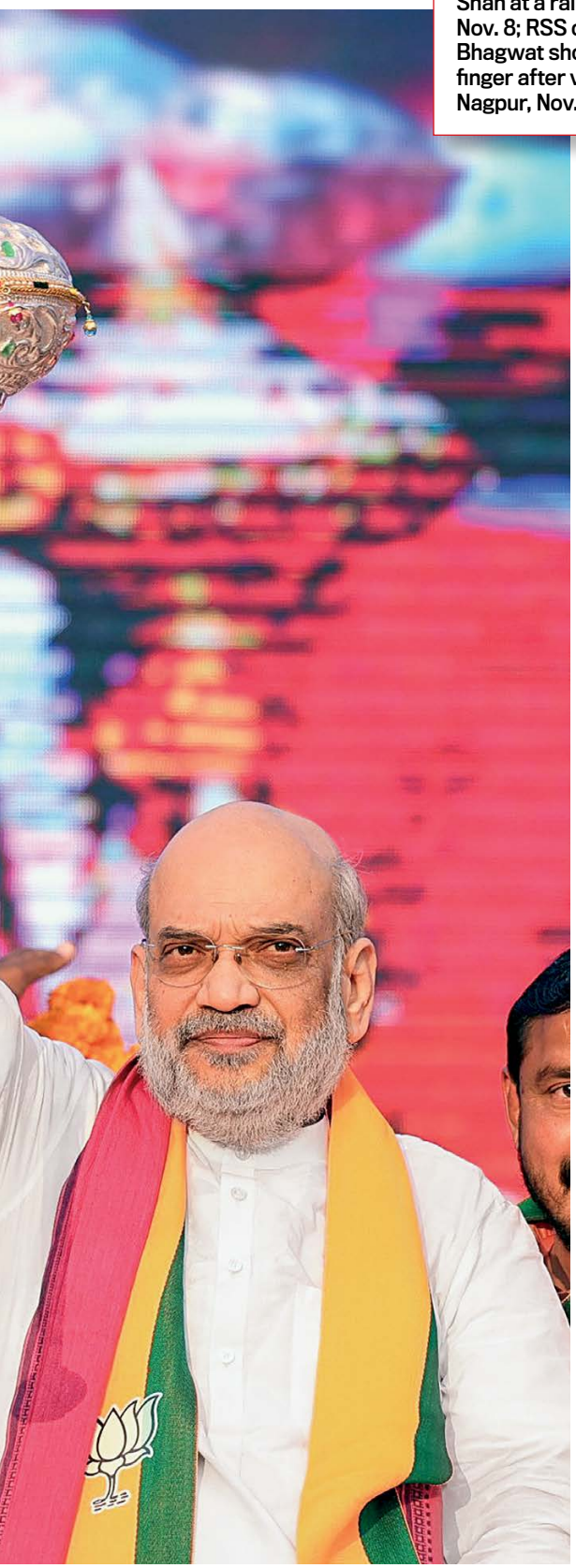
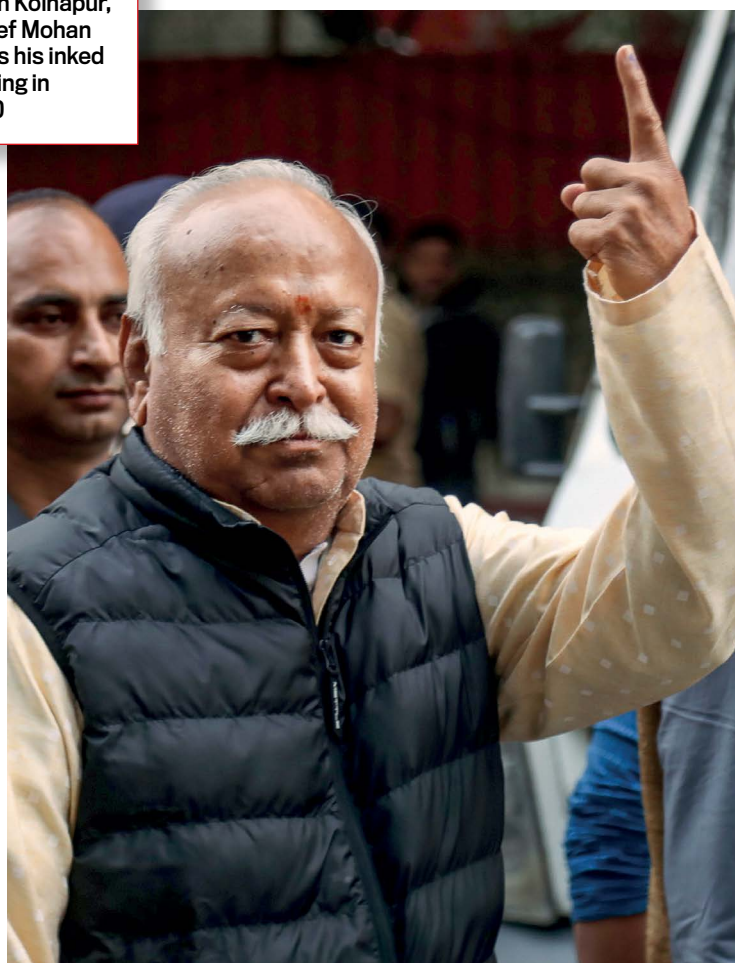
LET THE INK DRY
(Below) BJP leader Amit Shah at a rally in Kolhapur, Nov. 8; RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat shows his inked finger after voting in Nagpur, Nov. 20





Photographs: ANI

OLD GAME, NEW RULES

- **RSS back on level terms with the BJP, proves that the organisation is indispensable to the party's poll victories**
- **PM Modi now being positioned to show his softer side, polarising bad boy Hindutva talk is left to leaders like Yogi Adityanath and Himanta Biswa Sarma**
- **Local satraps get more say in campaign strategy, candidate election, allowed to 'innovate' if it brings results**
- **Localisation is key in state campaigns, region- or seat-specific issues take primacy over national ones**
- **For all the talk about 'revdi' culture, cash dole schemes like Ladki Bahin set up the BJP's wins**